

◀ VISIGOTHS IN SPAIN

The Visigoths (western Goths) were among a

group of early Germanic people to cross into the Roman Empire in 376 CE. They founded a kingdom in southern Gaul, which later included much of modern-day Spain. Visigothic jewelers made eagle brooches decorated with colored glass and gemstones called garnets. The eagle was a popular design, adopted from Roman imperial insignia.



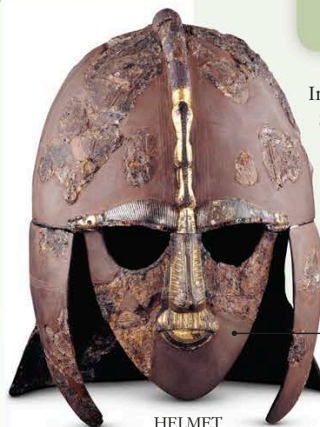
▲ FRANKS IN GAUL

In the late 5th century, the Franks, who had settled in the region of western Europe called Gaul, were united into a single nation by their king, Clovis I (reigned 481–511 CE). In 496 CE, he converted to Christianity (above). Gaul came to be known as Francia (modern-day France)—the land of the Franks.

Red garnets embedded in a metal frame

SUTTON HOO TREASURES

In the 620s, an Anglo-Saxon king was buried at Sutton Hoo (in modern-day Suffolk, UK) in a ship filled with royal treasure. An excavation in 1939 uncovered several artifacts, including a helmet based on a Roman design, a richly decorated belt buckle, a lid for a purse, and other valuable items.



HELMET

Mask attached to helmet to protect the warrior's face

PURSE LID



BELT BUCKLE